UNIT 1 · TOPIC 7(B)

Sugarcane Equipment

Syllabus topic: Special equipment for crops: vegetables, sugarcane, cotton, groundnut, potato and fruit crops

Planting

A **sugarcane cutter-planter** does all of this in one pass:

1. Cuts whole cane into setts (**2–3 bud**) in the furrow.
2. Places the setts.
3. Applies fertilizer + insecticide.
4. Covers the setts.

- **Ring-pit digger** for ring-pit planting.
- **Ratoon management device (RMD):** stubble shaving, off-barring and fertilizer placement in the ratoon crop.

Harvesting — chopper-type harvester

1. The **base cutter** (counter-rotating discs) cuts the stalks.
2. **Feed rollers** carry them in.
3. The chopper cuts them into **billets (25–30 cm)**.
4. **Primary/secondary extractor fans** remove the trash.
5. An **elevator** delivers the billets to an infield trailer.

- **Whole-stalk harvesters** cut and windrow the cane.
- Other equipment: sugarcane stubble shaver, detrasher.
- Crushing is a processing step — no field equipment is covered here.
- Sugarcane crushers fall under the Dangerous Machines (Regulation) Act, 1983.
- Sugarcane harvesting remains one of the least mechanized operations in India (Topic 1a).

Practice MCQs

Q30. Sugarcane cutter-planter plants:

(a) Whole cane
(b) 2–3 bud setts cut in the furrow
(c) Seedlings
(d) Single-bud chips only

Q59. Chopper-type sugarcane harvesters deliver cane as:

(a) Whole stalks
(b) 25–30 cm billets
(c) Bagasse
(d) Shredded trash

Answers

Q30 — (b) 2–3 bud setts cut in the furrow

Q59 — (b) 25–30 cm billets